

John Snow

Physician, Epidemiologist, Anesthesiologist

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🌐 www.waterborne-disease.org

Summary

Highly influential physician and research scientist recognized as one of the founding fathers of modern epidemiology. Pioneered the use of spatial analysis and scientific methodology to investigate disease transmission, fundamentally challenging prevailing miasma theory and establishing the waterborne nature of cholera. Also a distinguished pioneer in the field of anesthesiology.

Professional Experience

Epidemiological Research & Consulting

- 1854 **Lead Investigator, Cholera Outbreak**, *Broad Street and St. James Parish*, London, England
- Successfully identified the source of the severe 1854 cholera epidemic in the Soho district as a public water pump, challenging the established medical consensus (miasma theory).
 - Employed groundbreaking statistical mapping and door-to-door data collection to correlate cholera cases with proximity to specific water sources, demonstrating a clear pattern of waterborne transmission.
 - Provided definitive evidence leading to the removal of the Broad Street pump handle, which is historically credited with halting the spread of the epidemic.

- 1846–1858 **Pioneer in Anesthesiology**, *Various Hospitals and Private Practice*, London, England
- Developed and refined apparatus for the safe and controlled administration of ether and chloroform, significantly improving patient outcomes during surgical procedures.
 - Published *On the Inhalation of the Vapor of Ether* (1847) and *On Chloroform and Other Anaesthetics* (1858), detailing physiological effects and safe dosage.
 - Administered chloroform to Queen Victoria during the birth of Prince Leopold in 1853, cementing the practice's acceptance in Britain.

Education

- 1838–1844 **Doctor of Medicine (M.D.)**, *University of London*, London, England
Completed studies under the new regulations, focusing on anatomy, physiology, and pathology.
- 1832–1836 **Surgical Apprenticeship**, *Newcastle-upon-Tyne*, England
Trained extensively under a general practitioner, covering broad surgical and medical knowledge.
- 1838 **Member**, *Royal College of Surgeons of England*
Granted Licentiate of the Society of Apothecaries.

Skills & Competencies

- Epidemiological Investigation
- Clinical Medicine & Surgery

Statistical Mapping (Geographic Analysis)Anesthesiology (Ether & Chloroform)

- Public Health Policy

Medical EthicsWater Quality Analysis

Key Publications

- Snow, J. (1855). *On the Mode of Communication of Cholera*. Second Edition. John Churchill.
- Snow, J. (1847). *On the Inhalation of the Vapor of Ether*. John Churchill.
- Numerous articles and papers on respiration, asphyxia, and the circulation of the blood.

Societies

- Member, Westminster Medical Society
- Member, Medical Society of London